The exact IMAGES prompt

A small handoff from Claude Code to Codex, inside your project.

01 / Copy the original

> Use the Codex CLI to generate [a warm photo of a desk with a hand-drawn plan] and save it in [assets/img]. Show me the file when it's done.

This is the verbatim prompt from the Use Both production site. Replace the bracketed image description and output folder. Paste it into Claude Code in the local project where you want the image.

02 / Check the setup

You need Claude Code with terminal access, plus Codex CLI installed and signed in. A normal browser chat cannot invoke the CLI on your computer. Claude access is separate from your ChatGPT plan.

Install Codex from the official guide: developers.openai.com/codex/cli. In your project terminal, run codex, choose Sign in with ChatGPT, and finish sign-in yourself. Never paste passwords or tokens into the prompt.

Before generation, ask Claude to check codex --version and codex login status. The current Codex session must also expose an image-generation tool. Installation alone does not prove that it does.

03 / Know what the cost claim means

The recorded workflow used the existing ChatGPT-backed Codex allowance. Usage limits still apply. Plan eligibility and tool availability can change. Do not assume unlimited images, and do not silently switch to API billing.

Make the handoff reliable

Use this expanded version when you want explicit checks.

Copyable adaptation

Use the Codex CLI to generate one image of [SUBJECT], in [ASPECT RATIO], for [USE]. Save it as [PROJECT-RELATIVE PATH, e.g. assets/img/desk.png].

First confirm that Codex is available, signed in with my ChatGPT account, and has an image-generation tool in this session. Do not switch to an API key, paid service, new account or subscription. If the tool is unavailable, stop and explain what is missing.

Use the actual image-generation tool. Keep existing files intact. Show me the resulting image and its actual saved path. If a generation or save fails, report the failure; do not substitute a placeholder or claim success.

Confirm the result before you use it

1. Open the returned file from the actual project folder. A status message or a path in chat is not proof that the file exists.

2. Inspect dimensions, framing, faces, hands and any text. Check logos and factual labels against their real sources; image generation can invent them.

3. Ask Claude to place the verified file into your page or document, then open the finished layout. Keep the original image so you can revise the layout without regenerating.

A practical example

Subject: a warm photo of a desk with a hand-drawn plan. Use: a landing-page hero. Shape: 16:9. Output: assets/img/desk.png. Request one draft first, inspect it, then describe a specific revision.

When it does not work

Stop at the failed step instead of buying a workaround by accident.

Codex is missing or signed out

Install from the official Codex CLI guide. Run codex in your project and sign in with ChatGPT. Restart the Claude terminal session if it cannot see a newly installed command.

The CLI session has no image-generation tool

Do not ask it to fake a photo with code or claim it generated an image. Open an image-capable Codex app/session, generate the image there, save it into the same project folder, and return to Claude. This fallback is a manual handoff, not the automatic CLI route shown in the reel.

It says done, but there is no file

Ask for the exact saved path and inspect that folder. If generation returned an image without saving it, save or download the real output. Do not accept a placeholder, screenshot of a prompt, or invented filename.

You hit a usage or permission limit

Read the actual limit or permission message. Wait for the allowance to reset or choose an already-authorized route. Do not disable safeguards or add paid services just to force this example through.

Sources and scope

Original workflow: youtube.com/watch?v=ucer2chlfM8, 04:55-05:21. Original prompt: the Use Both production site image-prompt card. The expanded template in this guide is an adaptation.

Current CLI installation and ChatGPT sign-in: developers.openai.com/codex/cli. Local codex exec help checked 11 October 2026. No fresh end-to-end image generation or universal plan availability is claimed by this guide.